

venting the use of such files on portable MP3 players. Unfortunately, if the MP3 is protected, there is little you can do to play it.

Windows Media Player Woes

Older versions of Windows Media Player have a bug that causes sound to distort when the equaliser is set to anything but the default, and you decide to repeat playback for the file. The only way to prevent this is to disable the equaliser in the Now Playing Options under the View menu, click Graphic Equalizer and then click the "On" option to switch the equaliser off.

Online Woes

Streaming audio is extremely prone to skips and distortions, depending on the speed of your Internet connection. So unless you have a *really* fast connection, close applications such as download accelerators, P2P applications, etc., while you are listening to Internet radio.

If you're trying to stream an audio file, hit Pause on your media player, let the file download completely, and then click play.

Strange Beautiful Music

We didn't believe it at first, but if it's on Microsoft's Knowledge Base, it must be true!

"During normal operation or in Safe mode, your computer may play "Fur Elise" or "It's a Small, Small World" seemingly at random. This is an indication sent to the PC speaker from the computer's BIOS that the CPU fan is failing or has failed, or that the power supply voltages have drifted out of tolerance. This is a design feature of a detection circuit and system BIOSes developed by Award/Unicore from 1997 on."

Link: <http://support.microsoft.com/?kbid=261186>